ERA 5

The Era of Jefferson

1800 – 1817

Jeffersonian democracy · the Louisiana Purchase · the Marshall Court

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did Jefferson's presidency and the Marshall Court expand the reach of the nation — and the federal government?

KEY TERMS

Revolution of 1800 · Louisiana Purchase · Embargo Act · Marbury v. Madison · judicial review · McCulloch v. Maryland

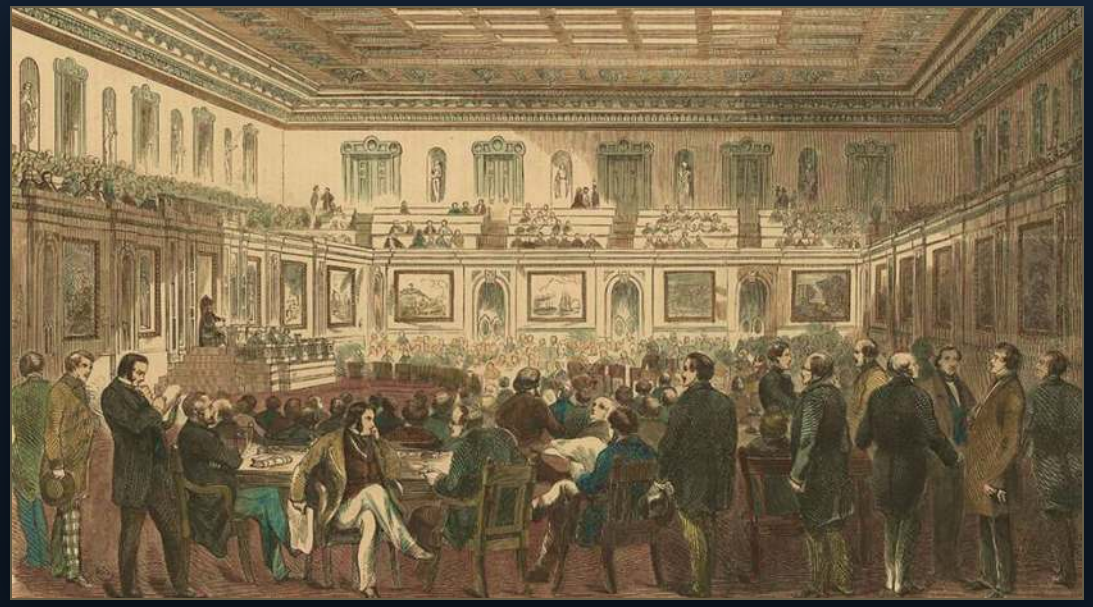
ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 4.2 · AMSCO Ch. 4.2

SECTION

The Election of 1800

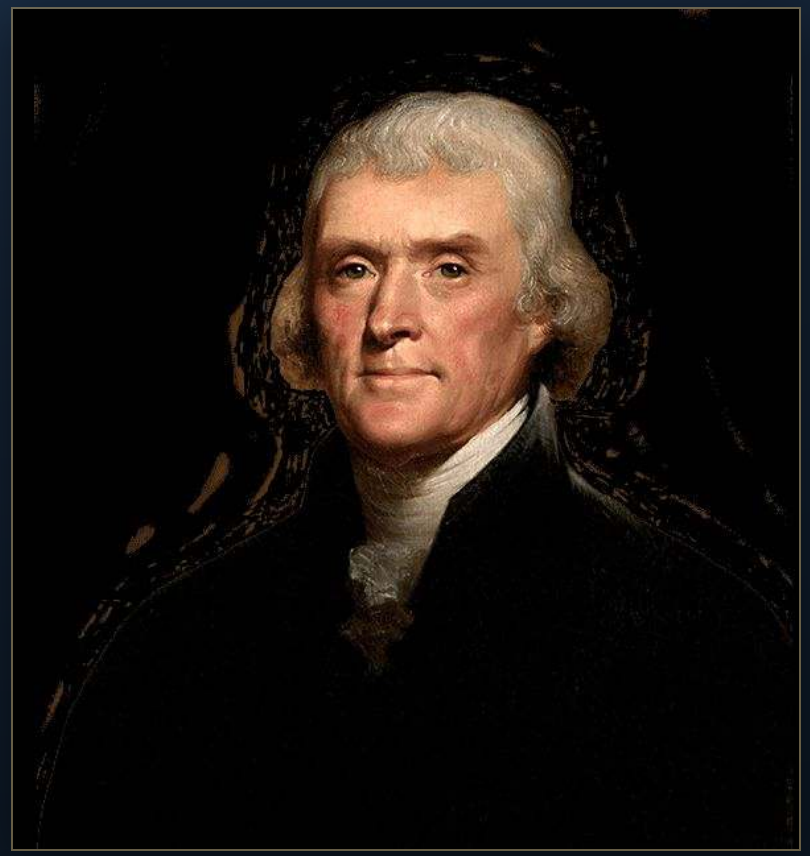
A Peaceful Revolution



- The bitter election was decided in the House after 36 ballots.
- **Jefferson**'s win was the first peaceful transfer of power between parties.
- He called it a **'Revolution of 1800'**—as real as 1776.

The Jeffersonian Vision

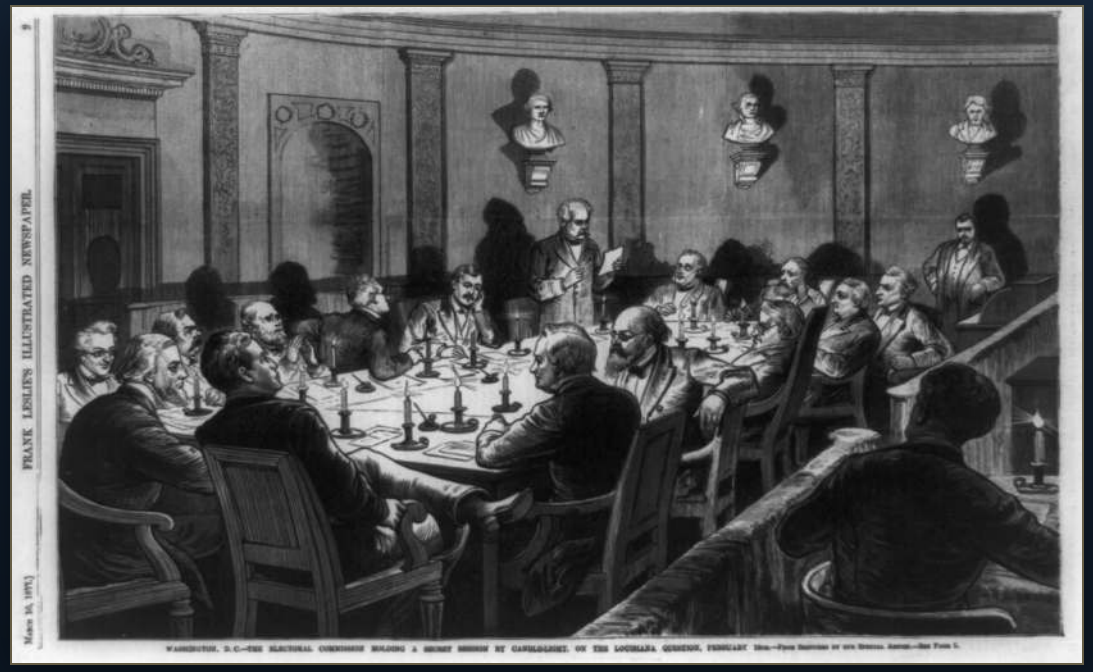
- Jefferson dreamed of an **agrarian republic** of independent farmers.
- He shrank the government, the army, and the national debt.
- He began the **Virginia Dynasty**—Jefferson, Madison, Monroe.



SECTION

The Louisiana Purchase

Doubling the Nation



- Jefferson sought to buy **New Orleans**; **Napoleon** offered all of Louisiana.
- In 1803 the U.S. bought it for about $15 million.
- The **Louisiana Purchase** doubled the size of the country.

Jefferson's Constitutional Dilemma

NEED

Access to Trade

The U.S. needed the port of New Orleans.

→

OFFER

All of Louisiana

Napoleon offered the entire territory—cheap.

→

CONFLICT

Strict Construction

The Constitution never mentions buying land.

→

CHOICE

He Bought It

Jefferson set his principles aside for the good of the nation.

Lewis & Clark

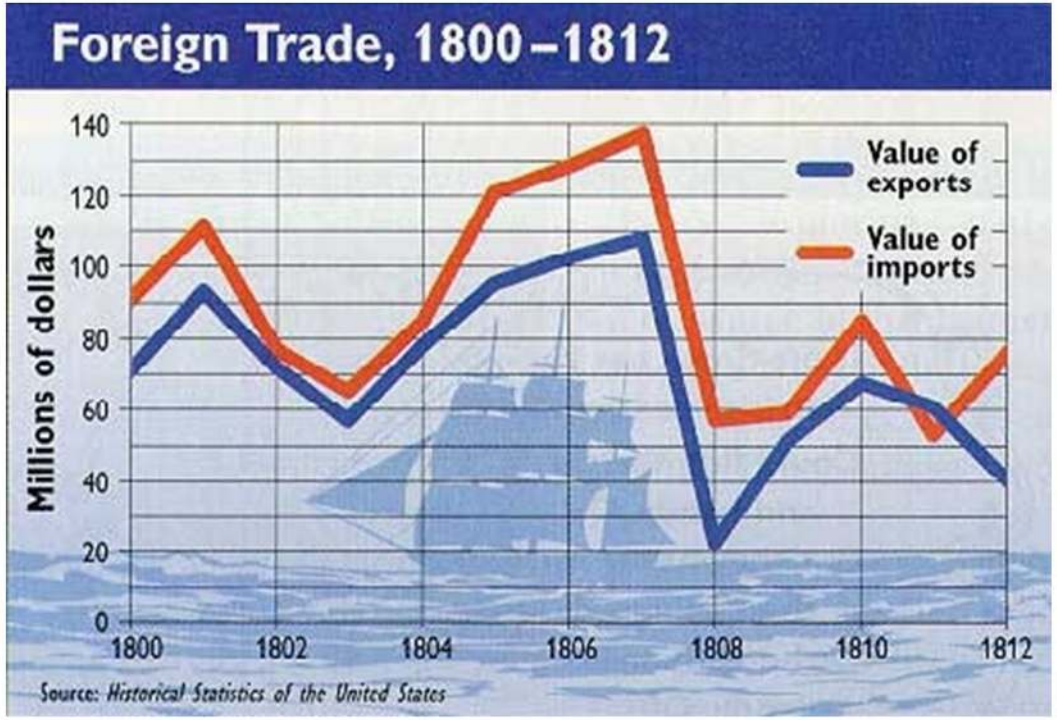
- Jefferson sent **Lewis and Clark** to explore the new territory.
- Guided in part by Sacagawea, they reached the Pacific and returned.
- They mapped the West and catalogued its peoples and resources.



SECTION

The Embargo Act, 1807

The Embargo Backfires



- Britain and France seized U.S. ships and impressed American sailors.
- Jefferson's **Embargo Act** banned ALL exports to punish them.
- It devastated the U.S. economy instead—exports collapsed.

SECTION

The Marshall Court

Marbury v. Madison, 1803



- Chief Justice **John Marshall** ruled on a dispute over a judicial appointment.
- He established the power of **judicial review**.
- The Court could now strike down laws that violate the Constitution.

McCulloch v. Maryland, 1819

- Maryland tried to tax the **national bank**.
- Marshall ruled that states cannot tax federal institutions.
- The decision affirmed federal supremacy and **loose construction**.



The Marshall Court's Legacy

Marshall made the Supreme Court a coequal branch

CASE	YEAR	WHAT IT ESTABLISHED
Marbury v. Madison	1803	**Judicial review**—the Court can void unconstitutional laws
Fletcher v. Peck	1810	States cannot break contracts
McCulloch v. Maryland	1819	Federal supremacy and implied powers

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Era of Jefferson

1. The **'Revolution of 1800'** was the first peaceful transfer of power, launching the Democratic-Republican **Virginia Dynasty**.

2. The **Louisiana Purchase** doubled the nation and forced Jefferson to bend his strict-construction principles.

3. **John Marshall's Court**—through **Marbury v. Madison** and **McCulloch v. Maryland**—permanently strengthened federal and judicial power.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Era of Jefferson

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

Explain how **Marbury v. Madison** permanently changed the power of the Supreme Court.

ARGUMENTATION

Was Jefferson a **hypocrite or a pragmatist** in making the Louisiana Purchase? Defend your claim with evidence.

COMPARISON

Compare Jefferson's **stated principles** with his **actions** in office.

Up next — **Lesson 12: America on the World Stage** (the War of 1812 & the Era of Good Feelings)